

Grade 4 FAST ELA Reading

Test Release: 2026

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Introduction

Section 1008.22(8), Florida Statutes (F.S.), requires the Department to publish each statewide, standardized assessment administered, excluding retakes, at least once on a triennial basis, with the initial publication occurring after the Spring 2024 test administration. The initial publication of assessments was required to include, at a minimum, the grade 3 Mathematics and English Language Arts (ELA) Reading assessments, the grade 10 ELA Reading assessment and the Algebra 1 End-of-Course (EOC) Assessment. Per statute, released content must have appeared on tests in the administration year immediately preceding release. Based on those requirements, below is a proposed timeline for the release of operational tests beginning with the 2023–24 school year.

June 2024	June 2025	June 2026
Grade 3 Mathematics & ELA Reading	Grade 5 Mathematics & ELA Reading	Grade 4 Mathematics & ELA Reading
Grade 6 Mathematics & ELA Reading	Grade 8 Mathematics & ELA Reading	Grade 7 Mathematics & ELA Reading
Grade 8 Science	Grade 5 Science	Biology 1 EOC
Grade 10 ELA Reading	Grade 9 ELA Reading	
Algebra 1 EOC	Geometry EOC	
Civics EOC	U.S. History EOC	
Annually: Grades 4–10 Writing prompts and individual student responses		

The purpose of the released tests is to promote transparency in the statewide, standardized assessment program and to increase the comfort level of students and parents with the state assessments. Students, parents, and teachers should use the released tests to better understand the types of items on Florida's K–12 statewide assessments.

Each released test will include content that represents an operational test blueprint for each respective assessment. The released tests can also be used to illustrate the length of an operational test and the range of difficulties of the questions on that test.

Each released test will include an answer key, the percentage of students that answered that item correctly, the item's reporting category, and the item benchmark information.

Released tests can be accessed through the Sample Items card on the Florida Statewide Assessments Portal.

For more information about K–12 assessments, please visit https://www.fldoe.org/accountability/assessments/k-12-student-assessment/.

For questions related to this document or released tests in general, please contact Assessment@fldoe.org.

from *What Are the Parts of Government?*

by William David Thomas

1 Kylie really liked basketball. Her older sister, Kelcey, was a star on the high school team. Kelcey was also a star in the classroom, and she was helping Kylie get ready for a social studies test.

2 "I just don't get it!" said Kylie.

3 "Well look," said Kelcey, "the government is a lot like basketball."

4 "You have got to be kidding!"

5 "I'm serious," said Kelcey. "The U.S. Constitution is the highest law in the land. It sets up three parts, or branches, of government. They're the executive branch, the legislative branch, and the judicial branch. Each one has a different job to do." . . .

The President

6 The president heads up the executive branch of government. The U.S. Constitution says the president must "take care that the laws be faithfully **executed**." To enforce the laws, the president has certain powers.

- As chief executive, the president oversees the major offices of the U.S. government. The president chooses the people who lead those offices.
- The president is commander-in-chief of the armed forces, which includes the Army, Navy, Air Force, and Marines.
- The president can make **treaties** with foreign countries.
- The president may veto, or reject, a bill passed by Congress.
- As head of state, the president is a symbol of the nation. The president represents the country at home and abroad.

7 The president has great powers. But those powers are controlled by the Constitution. The system is called "checks and balances." It keeps any part of the government from becoming too powerful. For example, the president commands the armed forces. However, only Congress can declare war. The president can make treaties with foreign countries. But the treaties must be approved by Congress before they can go into effect.

The Vice President

8 The vice president is the second highest-ranking person in the government. The vice president becomes president if:

- the president dies in office (this has happened eight times)
- the president resigns (this has only happened once)
- the president is removed from office by Congress (this has never happened)

9 The Constitution gives the vice president one responsibility—president of the Senate. If a vote in the Senate ends in a tie, the vice president votes to break the tie. The vice president also works with leaders in Congress and helps the president make decisions.

10 Long ago, there was no vice presidential candidate on the ballot. People only voted for the president. The person with the most votes became president. The person in second place became the vice president. This was changed by the Twelfth Amendment to the Constitution. Since 1804, people have voted for the president and vice president as a team. . . .

Federal Agencies

11 Many federal agencies are part of the executive branch, too. These agencies advise the president on such things as national security, . . . trade, the budget, and science. Some of these agencies are:

- the Central Intelligence Agency (CIA)
- the National Aeronautics and Space Administration (NASA)
- the Environmental Protection Agency (EPA)

12 Altogether, nearly three million people work in the executive branch. With the president, they "take care that the laws be faithfully executed." . . .

The Powers of Congress

13 Congress is the legislative branch of the government. That means it is the law-making branch. Congress meets in the U.S. Capitol in Washington, D.C.

14 Congress does much more than make laws. The Constitution gives this branch of government many powers. . . .

One Congress, Two Houses

15 Congress has two parts, or houses. The House of Representatives has 435 members. Each state has a different number of representatives. The number depends on the state's population. California has fifty-three representatives. Vermont has only one. Members of the House serve a term that lasts two years. They can be re-elected many times.

16 The other house of Congress is the Senate. There are one hundred senators. Each state has two senators, no matter what the population. Each senator serves a term of six years. They too may be re-elected. . . .

The Supreme Court

17 The Supreme Court is the highest court in the United States. Its most important job is to **interpret** the U.S. Constitution. The Constitution was written more than two hundred years ago. The Court must decide how the rules in the Constitution apply to what happens today.

18 The Court can decide that a law is unconstitutional. If that happens, the law is nullified. That means it is no longer a law. The Court can also decide that actions taken by Congress or the president are unconstitutional. If so, those actions must stop.

19 There are no **juries** in the Supreme Court. There are nine judges, called justices. One of them is the chief justice. When the Court hears a case, all nine justices listen. They discuss the case. Then they vote. A simple majority—just five votes—is all that is needed to decide a case. . . .

20 The Supreme Court has made decisions about slavery, religion, and even presidential elections. The Court's rulings are often controversial. The justices have to stay calm and think clearly. Oliver Wendell Holmes was a famous justice. He once said, "We are very quiet here, but it is the quiet of a storm center."

Glossary

executed: put into effect

treaties: agreements

interpret: explain

juries: people who make decisions in a case

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1. What is the text structure of paragraph 19?

Ⓐ description
Ⓑ chronology
Ⓒ problem and solution
Ⓓ compare and contrast

Answer Key: A

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 53%

Reporting Category: Reading Informational Text

Benchmark: ELA.4.R.2.1

Benchmark Description: Explain how text features contribute to the meaning and identify the text structures of problem/solution, sequence, and description in texts.

2. What is the text structure of the section **The President**?

Ⓐ chronology
Ⓑ description
Ⓒ problem and solution
Ⓓ compare and contrast

Answer Key: B

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 59%

Reporting Category: Reading Informational Text

Benchmark: ELA.4.R.2.1

Benchmark Description: Explain how text features contribute to the meaning and identify the text structures of problem/solution, sequence, and description in texts.

3. How does the author support the claim that the Supreme Court is an important part of the government?

Ⓐ by explaining how old the Supreme Court is

Ⓑ by explaining the powers of the Supreme Court

Ⓒ by telling how people are chosen for the Supreme Court

Ⓓ by telling the kinds of laws the Supreme Court has written

Answer Key: B

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 58%

Reporting Category: Reading Informational Text

Benchmark: ELA.4.R.2.4

Benchmark Description: Explain an author's claim and the reasons and evidence used to support the claim.

4. Read this sentence from the passage.

3 “Well look,” said Kelcey, “the government is a lot like basketball.”

What does the figurative language in this sentence show about the government?

Ⓐ It shows why the government follows certain rules.

Ⓑ It shows why sports are important to the government.

Ⓒ It hints that the government has parts that work together.

Ⓓ It shows how challenging working for the government can be.

Answer Key: C

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 43%

Reporting Category: Reading Across Genres & Vocabulary

Benchmark: ELA.4.R.3.1

Benchmark Description: Explain how figurative language contributes to meaning in text(s).

5. This question has two parts. First, answer Part A. Then, answer Part B.

Part A

What is a claim the author makes in the passage?

Ⓐ Voting was easier many years ago.

Ⓑ Making a law can be a lengthy process.

Ⓒ Each state should have the same number of representatives.

Ⓓ The power of the president is limited by how the government is designed.

Part B

Which detail from the passage supports the claim in Part A?

Ⓐ "For example, the president commands the armed forces. However, only Congress can declare war." (paragraph 7)

Ⓑ "Since 1804, people have voted for the president and vice president as a team." (paragraph 10)

Ⓒ "Congress is the legislative branch of the government. That means it is the law-making branch." (paragraph 13)

Ⓓ "The House of Representatives has 435 members." (paragraph 15)

Answer Key: D and A

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 35%

Reporting Category: Reading Informational Text

Benchmark: ELA.4.R.2.4

Benchmark Description: Explain an author's claim and the reasons and evidence used to support the claim.

6. Which **two** details belong in a summary of the passage?

Ⓐ Congress helps make laws for the country.
Ⓑ Each branch of government has an important job.
Ⓒ About three million people work in the executive branch.
Ⓓ California has fifty-three representatives, and Vermont has one.
Ⓔ The legislative branch meets at a large building in Washington, D.C.

Answer Key: A, B

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 46%

Reporting Category: Reading Across Genres & Vocabulary

Benchmark: ELA.4.R.3.2

Benchmark Description: Summarize a text to enhance comprehension.

7. Read this sentence from the passage.

"To enforce the laws, the president has certain powers." (paragraph 6)

Based on the prefix *en-*, what does the word enforce mean?

Ⓐ to find easily
Ⓑ to change often
Ⓒ to write privately
Ⓓ to make happen

Answer Key: D

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 61%

Reporting Category: Reading Across Genres & Vocabulary

Benchmark: ELA.4.V.1.2

Benchmark Description: Apply knowledge of common Greek and Latin roots, base words, and affixes to determine the meaning of unfamiliar words in grade-level content.

Passage 1: The Great Seal of the United States

by Terri DeGezelle

Symbol of a New Nation

1 In 1782, the Great Seal became a symbol of a new nation. Since then, the seal has been used to mark important papers. Many images make up the Great Seal. These images stand for beliefs like freedom and peace. The United States was founded on these beliefs.

A New Nation

2 In 1776, the 13 American colonies declared their freedom from Great Britain. Men from each colony met in Pennsylvania. They formed a new nation.

3 The new nation needed a symbol. From 1776 to 1781, Congress asked many people to help design the seal. But Congress rejected all of their ideas.

Congress Approves

4 In 1782, Congress asked Charles Thomson to design the seal. Thomson used parts of the rejected ideas in his design. On June 20, 1782, Congress approved Thomson's design. The United States finally had a seal to represent the country. They called it the Great Seal.

The Front of the Great Seal

5 The bald eagle represents freedom. The olive branch stands for peace. The arrows show that the United States will fight for its freedom.

6 The U.S. motto on the ribbon is written in Latin. It means, "Out of many, one." One country was made from 13 states. Thirteen stars stand for each state.

The Back of the Great Seal

7 The pyramid represents America's strength. . . . The words on the seal are in Latin. The top words mean, "He favors our undertakings." The bottom words mean, "New order of the ages."

The Great Seal Today

8 Today, the Great Seal **die** is kept in the Department of State building in Washington, D.C. The seal is put on important papers.

9 The Great Seal is still a symbol of the United States. The seal reminds people of freedom and peace.

Glossary

die: a special tool used to cut or form something into a particular shape or pattern

"The Great Seal of the United States" by Terri DeGezelle. Copyright © 2004 by Capstone Press. Reprinted by permission of Capstone Press via Copyright Clearance Center.

Passage 2: A Seal in the Making

10 The Great Seal of the United States is a symbol of power and authority as a nation. It is seen throughout the rooms of the White House, on passports, and on U.S. one-dollar bills. But how did the idea of the seal come to life? It wasn't a quick and simple process.

The Beginning Stages

11 Congress wanted an emblem that showed the power and authority of the United States. It needed to reflect the freedom of the people and the high hopes for the future of the country. The first committee had the challenge of finding a way to translate these ideas into an image. Some ideas worked well, but ultimately it left Congress feeling unsatisfied.

The Second Attempt

12 With the first committee failing, it was back to the drawing board. In March 1780, a new committee was formed. Francis Hopkinson, the man who designed the American flag, was asked to serve as a guide while making a new design.

13 Influenced by the American flag, Hopkinson's committee added 13 red and white stripes symbolizing the 13 colonies. A **constellation** of 13 six-pointed stars and an olive branch, a symbol of peace, were part of the design. While these features are part of the final seal, Congress still declined the committee's idea.

Third Time's a Charm?

14 After two failed designs, Congress appointed a third committee with high hopes of being successful. This committee relied heavily on William Barton, an artistic lawyer, to nail this design. Barton's committee added a small white eagle spreading its wings, a small flag, and a pyramid to the previous design. In May 1782, he drew up two designs, but Congress still rejected both ideas.

A New Plan

15 Congress decided to present the works of the three committees to the Secretary of Congress, Charles Thomson. Though not an artist, he could make tough decisions. He chose the best features from the previous design and got to work.

16 He replaced the former white eagle with the native American bald eagle. Its wings were extended, and a small flag was added. The bird's left talon held a bundle of arrows, and the right talon held an olive branch. Changes were made to the placement of other features too. Then, the rough sketches were given back to Barton for the final touches.

Finishing Touches

17 Barton made a simpler version of Thomson's flag and alternated the white and red vertical stripes. He made it clear that the number of arrows in the eagle's talon numbered 13. The eagle's wing tips also were turned upward.

18 The design was sent back to Thomson on June 19, 1782, and he then added a written description of the seal with explanations for the changes. The final product was presented to Congress on June 20. Finally, after six years and the combined efforts of 14 men, Charles Thomson and William Barton were deemed successful when Congress approved this design.



Charles Thomson's design for the Great Seal of the United States, 1782



The final product of the Great Seal, still used today

Glossary

constellation: a group of stars that appear as a pattern or picture

"A Seal in the Making." Written for educational purposes. Images: "US Great Seal Graham Lithograph" by Andrew B. Graham. In the public domain. "Design for the Verso of the Great Seal of the United States" by Charles Thomson. In the public domain.

8. In Passage 1, what is the text structure of the section **The Front of the Great Seal**?

Ⓐ description

Ⓑ chronology

Ⓒ problem and solution

Ⓓ compare and contrast

Answer Key: A

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 58%

Reporting Category: Reading Informational Text

Benchmark: ELA.4.R.2.1

Benchmark Description: Explain how text features contribute to the meaning and identify the text structures of problem/solution, sequence, and description in texts.

9. This question has two parts. First, answer Part A. Then, answer Part B.

Part A

What is a central idea of Passage 1?

Ⓐ The Great Seal has an olive branch for peace.

Ⓑ The Great Seal has been used on special documents.

Ⓒ The Great Seal is an important symbol to the United States.

Ⓓ The Great Seal die is kept in the Department of State building.

Part B

Which sentence from Passage 1 supports the answer in Part A?

Ⓐ "From 1776 to 1781, Congress asked many people to help design the seal." (paragraph 3)

Ⓑ "In 1782, Congress asked Charles Thomson to design the seal." (paragraph 4)

Ⓒ "The words on the seal are in Latin." (paragraph 7)

Ⓓ "The seal reminds people of freedom and peace." (paragraph 9)

Answer Key: C and D

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 60%

Reporting Category: Reading Informational Text

Benchmark: ELA.4.R.2.2

Benchmark Description: Explain how relevant details support the central idea, implied or explicit.

10. In Passage 1, which sentence supports the claim that there are different parts to the seal?

Ⓐ "In 1782, the Great Seal became a symbol of a new nation." (paragraph 1)

Ⓑ "Many images make up the Great Seal." (paragraph 1)

Ⓒ "On June 20, 1782, Congress approved Thomson's design." (paragraph 4)

Ⓓ "The United States finally had a seal to represent the country." (paragraph 4)

Answer Key: B

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 51%

Reporting Category: Reading Informational Text

Benchmark: ELA.4.R.2.4

Benchmark Description: Explain an author's claim and the reasons and evidence used to support the claim.

11. How does the image add meaning to Passage 2?

Ⓐ It shows why the seal has an eagle.

Ⓑ It shows how details in the seal changed.

Ⓒ It shows what each person contributed to the seal.

Ⓓ It shows why some ideas were removed from the seal.

Answer Key: B

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 68%

Reporting Category: Reading Informational Text

Benchmark: ELA.4.R.2.1

Benchmark Description: Explain how text features contribute to the meaning and identify the text structures of problem/solution, sequence, and description in texts.

12. In Passage 2, which sentence supports the central idea that many people were involved in making the seal?

Ⓐ "A constellation of 13 six-pointed stars and an olive branch, a symbol of peace, were part of the design." (paragraph 13)

Ⓑ "In May 1782, he drew up two designs, but Congress still rejected both ideas." (paragraph 14)

Ⓒ "Congress decided to present the works of the three committees to the Secretary of Congress, Charles Thomson." (paragraph 15)

Ⓓ "Though not an artist, he could make tough decisions." (paragraph 15)

Answer Key: C

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 52%

Reporting Category: Reading Informational Text

Benchmark: ELA.4.R.2.2

Benchmark Description: Explain how relevant details support the central idea, implied or explicit.

13. In Passage 2, which sentence shows the author's perspective about making the seal?

Ⓐ "It wasn't a quick and simple process." (paragraph 10)

Ⓑ "Some ideas worked well, but ultimately it left Congress feeling unsatisfied." (paragraph 11)

Ⓒ "He made it clear that the number of arrows in the eagle's talon numbered 13." (paragraph 17)

Ⓓ "The final product was presented to Congress on June 20." (paragraph 18)

Answer Key: A

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 53%

Reporting Category: Reading Informational Text

Benchmark: ELA.4.R.2.3

Benchmark Description: Explain an author's perspective toward a topic in an informational text.

14. Read this sentence from Passage 2.

"With the first committee failing, it was back to the drawing board." (paragraph 12)

How does the phrase "back to the drawing board" add meaning to the passage?

Ⓐ It suggests that the committee felt discouraged.

Ⓑ It suggests that the committee had great artists.

Ⓒ It shows that the committee had to start over again.

Ⓓ It shows that the committee looked closely over its ideas.

Answer Key: C

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 73%

Reporting Category: Reading Across Genres & Vocabulary

Benchmark: ELA.4.R.3.1

Benchmark Description: Explain how figurative language contributes to meaning in text(s).

15. Complete the table to show whether each statement is part of the central idea or is a supporting detail from Passage 2.

	Central Idea	Supporting Detail
The former white eagle was replaced with an American bald eagle on the Great Seal.	Ⓐ	Ⓑ
Different committees worked hard over many years to develop the final Great Seal.	Ⓒ	Ⓓ
Barton put the final touches on the Great Seal and sent it to Thomson for a written description.	Ⓔ	Ⓕ

Answer Key: B, C, F

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 55%

Reporting Category: Reading Informational Text

Benchmark: ELA.4.R.2.2

Benchmark Description: Explain how relevant details support the central idea, implied or explicit.

16. Read this sentence from Passage 2.

"This committee relied heavily on William Barton, an artistic lawyer, to nail this design." (paragraph 14)

How does the phrase "nail this design" add meaning to the passage?

Ⓐ It shows that the committee believed that Barton was handy.

Ⓑ It shows that the committee wanted Barton to do most of the work.

Ⓒ It shows that the committee wanted Barton to make the perfect seal.

Ⓓ It shows that the committee thought Barton was gifted at making seals.

Answer Key: C

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 63%

Reporting Category: Reading Across Genres & Vocabulary

Benchmark: ELA.4.R.3.1

Benchmark Description: Explain how figurative language contributes to meaning in text(s).

17. Based on Passage 2, select the phrase from the sentence that helps explain the meaning of the word translate.

"The Ⓐ first committee Ⓑ had the challenge of Ⓒ finding a way to translate these Ⓓ ideas into an image." (paragraph 11)

Answer Key: D

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 71%

Reporting Category: Reading Across Genres & Vocabulary

Benchmark: ELA.4.V.1.3

Benchmark Description: Use context clues, figurative language, word relationships, reference materials, and/or background knowledge to determine the meaning of multiple-meaning and unknown words and phrases, appropriate to grade level.

18. How do Passage 1 and Passage 2 present the process of making the seal differently?

Ⓐ Passage 1 focuses on committees that failed, while Passage 2 describes the successful ones.

Ⓑ Passage 1 highlights a single person who helped design the seal, while Passage 2 highlights many people.

Ⓒ Passage 1 tells why Congress was unhappy with the seal, while Passage 2 tells why Congress began to like it.

Ⓓ Passage 1 lists the parts of the seal that changed over time, while Passage 2 lists the parts that stayed the same.

Answer Key: B

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 43%

Reporting Category: Reading Across Genres & Vocabulary

Benchmark: ELA.4.R.3.3

Benchmark Description: Compare and contrast accounts of the same event using primary and/or secondary sources.

A Lovely Day for Litter

Outside my window, it looked cold and gray.
Mom knocked on my door as I hid in bed.
"Good morning! Isn't it a lovely day?
Come with me on my walk today," she said.

I groaned but got out of bed. When I spied
Mom had gloves and bags to pick up trash,
I groaned again. "Oh, please no, Mom!" I cried.
"Come on!" she said, "We'll be done in a flash."

So I put on my coat, trudged out after Mom,
Showing off a trash bag, to my dismay,
Like a fancy purse. She waved to Mr. Ransom:
"Good morning! Isn't it a lovely day?"

Mom tracked down scattered, wet note cards.
She plopped them in the bag and turned to say
To Ari and Jorge playing in their yards:
"Good morning! Isn't it a lovely day?"

I kicked a torn soccer ball with a sad sag
Behind my mom with a *thump, thump*.
"Great find!" she said, "Let's put it in the bag."
Shrugging, I put it in the bag for the dump.

"Good morning! Isn't it a lovely day?"
Mom said to a lady jogging past.
I ran after a can *whooshed* by the wind away,
And saw the sun peeking out at last.

I helped Mom untangle some balloon string
From a towering tree in the nearby park.
Like a cheery bird, Mom started to sing
And I hummed along like a little **lark**.

We got closer to home with a *clink*, and *swish*
Sounding from the trash bag. Mom grinned at me
As I waved hello at our neighbor Mrs. McClish:
"Good morning!" I said, "Isn't it a lovely day?"

As we threw away the bag of trash, Mom said to me,
"Isn't it lovely to make our street a nicer place to be?"

Glossary

lark: a type of songbird

"A Lovely Day for Litter" written for educational purposes.

19. This question has two parts. First, answer Part A. Then, answer Part B.

Part A

What is a theme of the poem?

Ⓐ It is responsible to care for the community.
Ⓑ It is important to show patience with others.
Ⓒ People should accept the differences of others.
Ⓓ People can solve problems when they work together.

Part B

Which line from the poem supports the answer in Part A?

Ⓐ “Outside my window, it looked cold and gray.” (line 1)
Ⓑ “‘Come on!’ she said, ‘We’ll be done in a flash.’” (line 8)
Ⓒ “Mom said to a lady jogging past.” (line 22)
Ⓓ “‘Isn’t it lovely to make our street a nicer place to be?’” (line 34)

Answer Key: A and D

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 63%

Reporting Category: Reading Prose and Poetry

Benchmark: ELA.4.R.1.2

Benchmark Description: Explain a stated or implied theme and how it develops, using details, in a literary text.

20. Which **two** details from the poem should be included in a summary?

Ⓐ The speaker and Mom pick up trash.
Ⓑ The speaker looks forward to sleeping late.
Ⓒ The speaker wears gloves while doing chores.
Ⓓ Mom admires the speaker finding an old soccer ball.
Ⓔ Mom enjoys caring for the neighborhood with the speaker.

Answer Key: A, E

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 61%

Reporting Category: Reading Across Genres & Vocabulary

Benchmark: ELA.4.R.3.2

Benchmark Description: Summarize a text to enhance comprehension.

21. How does the repetition of "'Good morning!' I said, 'Isn't it a lovely day?'" in line 32 reflect how the speaker changes in the poem?

Ⓐ It highlights how the speaker now prefers to wake up earlier.

Ⓑ It suggests that the speaker now plans to meet more neighbors.

Ⓒ It suggests that the speaker's work has become easier over time.

Ⓓ It highlights how the speaker's attitude about helping has improved.

Answer Key: D

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 65%

Reporting Category: Reading Prose and Poetry

Benchmark: ELA.4.R.1.4

Benchmark Description: Explain how rhyme and structure create meaning in a poem.

22. Select **two** lines that identify the speaker's point of view in the poem.

Ⓐ "Mom knocked on my door as I hid in bed." (line 2)
Ⓑ "'Come with me on my walk today,' she said." (line 4)
Ⓒ "Mom had gloves and bags to pick up trash," (line 6)
Ⓓ "I groaned again. 'Oh, please no, Mom!' I cried." (line 7)
Ⓔ "'Great find!' she said, 'Let's put it in the bag.'" (line 19)

Answer Key: A, D

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 48%

Reporting Category: Reading Prose and Poetry

Benchmark: ELA.4.R.1.3

Benchmark Description: Identify the narrator's point of view and explain the difference between a narrator's point of view and character perspective in a literary text.

23. Read these lines from the poem.

"Showing off a trash bag, to my dismay,
Like a fancy purse." (lines 10–11)

How does the figurative language in these lines contribute to the meaning of the poem? Select **two** answers.

Ⓐ by expressing how much the bag cost Mom

Ⓑ by describing how important cleaning is to Mom

Ⓒ by explaining how eager the speaker is to work alone

Ⓓ by highlighting how nice the trash bag looks to the speaker

Ⓔ by showing how proud Mom is to be helping the neighborhood

Answer Key: B, E

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 60%

Reporting Category: Reading Across Genres & Vocabulary

Benchmark: ELA.4.R.3.1

Benchmark Description: Explain how figurative language contributes to meaning in text(s).

24. Read this line from the poem.

"I helped Mom untangle some balloon string" (line 25)

The prefix *un-* means "not." What does the word untangle mean as it is used in this line?

Ⓐ to tie up

Ⓑ to put up high

Ⓒ to straighten out

Ⓓ to carry with care

Answer Key: C

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 83%

Reporting Category: Reading Across Genres & Vocabulary

Benchmark: ELA.4.V.1.2

Benchmark Description: Apply knowledge of common Greek and Latin roots, base words, and affixes to determine the meaning of unfamiliar words in grade-level content.

25. This question has two parts. First, answer Part A. Then, answer Part B.

Part A

What contributes to the change in the speaker?

Ⓐ Mom asks others to help out with the task.
Ⓑ Mom's cheerfulness makes the chore more fun.
Ⓒ The speaker's friends agree to help out with the task.
Ⓓ The speaker finds an important item that had been lost.

Part B

Which line from the poem supports the answer in Part A?

Ⓐ "Mom tracked down scattered, wet note cards." (line 13)
Ⓑ "To Ari and Jorge playing in their yards:" (line 15)
Ⓒ "I kicked a torn soccer ball with a sad sag" (line 17)
Ⓓ "Sounding from the trash bag. Mom grinned at me" (line 30)

Answer Key: B and D

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 48%

Reporting Category: Reading Prose and Poetry

Benchmark: ELA.4.R.1.1

Benchmark Description: Explain how setting, events, conflict, and character development contribute to the plot in a literary text.

26. How does the rhyme in lines 17–20 develop an idea about the speaker?

Ⓐ It calls attention to the speaker's desire to work hard.

Ⓑ It calls attention to the speaker's boredom with the task.

Ⓒ It points out the speaker's guilt about what happened to the toy.

Ⓓ It points out the speaker's confusion about the neighborhood route.

Answer Key: B

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 58%

Reporting Category: Reading Prose and Poetry

Benchmark: ELA.4.R.1.4

Benchmark Description: Explain how rhyme and structure create meaning in a poem.

Passage 1: The Greatest Show

"Let's go, dad. Today is the day.
The circus is here, now let's be on our way!"
Barely containing my excitement in the car,
I hope I have a chance to meet a big star.

While arriving at Madison Square Garden for the show,
Thousands of people entering, and we look for our row.
Mr. Barnum's acts were selected with great purpose,
Acrobats and an elephant are just the beginning of the circus.

The performers fill the stage, while I sat in great awe.
After each act I applaud at what I saw.
Mr. Barnum will come out on stage at the end,
With a grin he'll look out to the crowd and will bend.

After the show Mr. Barnum comes to greet
The fans standing in line, which feels like a treat.
I wait my turn, which takes quite a while.
Then, Mr. Barnum greets me with a shake and smile.

"Tell me, young man," Mr. Barnum says with glee,
"Did you like everything that you came to see?"
I nod my head, my whole face a large grin.
"It's the greatest show on Earth! Where to begin?"

Mr. Barnum chuckles, but I need to say more.
I want him to know how much I adore.
"For me, it wasn't just *any* show,
I too want to become a showman, you know."

Mr. Barnum's eyes begin filling with tears,
What I have said is like music to his ears.
"It's a challenging road to get to this point,
But with hard work and talent you won't disappoint."

I decide to take Mr. Barnum's words to heart.
I can't wait for the day that I have my big start,
With that I shook his hand one last time,
"This is an experience I will remember for a lifetime."

"The Greatest Show" written for educational purposes.

Passage 2: Meeting Mr. Barnum

by Patricia Baehr

Josephine and her brother Angelo have traveled through a snowstorm to see the famous P. T. Barnum circus. Josephine has always wanted to meet P. T. Barnum.

1 In the storm, the two blocks to Fourth Avenue and Twenty-fourth Street felt like miles. But at last Josephine saw a poster, cleared of ice, with the image of a large balding head with waves of hair as white as snow—Mr. P. T. Barnum himself. . . .

2 Madison Square Garden was the biggest building Josephine had ever seen. A smiling man with a droopy mustache showed her and Angelo where to go inside. He didn't check their tickets for seat numbers but led them straight to the front row, where they had a perfect view of three rings surrounded by a track. Though Josephine had heard the Garden had room for twelve thousand people, there were hardly more present than had been on the **el car**. She rubbed herself to get warm while listening to strange echoes made by more than a hundred shovels scraping snow off the roof. If she had any fears about whether the show would go on, they disappeared when the band started playing. The music was loud enough to drown out the sound of the shovels and the memory of the storm as well.

3 It was announced that all eighty-six acts would appear that day. Acrobats on high wires. The Siegrists, a family of gymnasts. Brave men taming big, ferocious cats. Elephants—Totonno's long-nosed animals—doing tricks. Costumed bears dancing, and a goat riding atop a galloping horse. There was a little girl named Flora Stirk who rode a bicycle and juggled. Then a lady with "moss hair" charmed a snake, and Madame Eliza Dockrill, the "Empress of the Arena," displayed her amazing skills on the back of a horse. Finally, Zazel the Human Cannonball exploded from the mouth of a canon, and ostriches and camels raced around the track with monkeys on their backs.

4 Nothing excited Josephine more, though, than the sight of a carriage rolling into the **arena**. When it stopped in the center ring, everything grew still. Josephine held her breath as [a] man in a suit and vest stood up to speak in a voice that was strong and clear.

5 "You came to see Barnum? Well, I'm Barnum. The storm may be a great show, but I still have the greatest show on earth!"

6 As the horse trotted out to the track, Josephine cheered so loudly that she hurt her throat. To her amazement, the carriage stopped directly in front of her.

7 "Are you having a good time?" Mr. Barnum asked, leaning down to shake Angelo's and Josephine's hands.

8 There she was: face to face with Mr. P. T. Barnum! Finally she could ask how he had made his fortunes! At last, she would know how to succeed in America—if only she could speak!

9 Angelo poked her hard in the ribs as the carriage pulled away to deposit Mr. Barnum in his special box seat. "Think what we went through," he **jeered**, "and you say nothing!"

10 Josephine leaned back and tried to forget her shame as the circus continued. Her gaze kept shifting to Mr. Barnum, though. He roared with delight and seemed to enjoy everything as much as if it were his first time at the circus, too. . . .

11 At the end of the show, Papa was outside waiting to see Josephine and Angelo home. . . .

12 Papa shook his head. "Only you and Mr. Barnum would think to go out on a day like today, Josephine. Only you and Mr. Barnum."

Glossary

el car: passenger section of a public subway train in New York City

arena: a large central area that is surrounded by seats for viewers

jeered: teased

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27. In Passage 1, how does meeting Mr. Barnum affect the speaker?

Ⓐ It teaches the speaker how a showman treats people.

Ⓑ It causes the speaker to appreciate the music at the circus.

Ⓒ It inspires the speaker to work hard to become a showman.

Ⓓ It makes the speaker want to learn more about circus animals.

Answer Key: C

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 65%

Reporting Category: Reading Prose and Poetry

Benchmark: ELA.4.R.1.1

Benchmark Description: Explain how setting, events, conflict, and character development contribute to the plot in a literary text.

28. In Passage 2, how does meeting Mr. Barnum in paragraph 8 affect Josephine?

Ⓐ It allows Josephine to learn more about him.

Ⓑ It helps Josephine to realize how talented he is.

Ⓒ It causes Josephine to feel ashamed after the conversation.

Ⓓ It leads Josephine to apologize for almost missing the circus.

Answer Key: C

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 37%

Reporting Category: Reading Prose and Poetry

Benchmark: ELA.4.R.1.1

Benchmark Description: Explain how setting, events, conflict, and character development contribute to the plot in a literary text.

29. Which **two** sentences from Passage 2 show that the passage is written in a third-person point of view?

Ⓐ "A smiling man with a droopy mustache showed her and Angelo where to go inside." (paragraph 2)

Ⓑ "The music was loud enough to drown out the sound of the shovels and the memory of the storm as well." (paragraph 2)

Ⓒ "Costumed bears dancing, and a goat riding atop a galloping horse." (paragraph 3)

Ⓓ "There was a little girl named Flora Stirk who rode a bicycle and juggled." (paragraph 3)

Ⓔ "There she was: face to face with Mr. P. T. Barnum!" (paragraph 8)

Answer Key: A, E

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 37%

Reporting Category: Reading Prose and Poetry

Benchmark: ELA.4.R.1.3

Benchmark Description: Identify the narrator's point of view and explain the difference between a narrator's point of view and character perspective in a literary text.

30. What is the point of view in Passage 1?

Ⓐ first person because the dad is describing the circus

Ⓑ third person because Barnum is talking to the audience

Ⓒ first person because the passage shows the thoughts of the speaker

Ⓓ third person because someone outside the story tells how Barnum became famous

Answer Key: C

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 66%

Reporting Category: Reading Prose and Poetry

Benchmark: ELA.4.R.1.3

Benchmark Description: Identify the narrator's point of view and explain the difference between a narrator's point of view and character perspective in a literary text.

31. What is the effect of the rhyming in Passage 1?

Ⓐ It highlights the difficult journey to get to Madison Square Garden.

Ⓑ It gives the speaker a more curious tone throughout certain events.

Ⓒ It reveals when Barnum decided to start his career as a showman.

Ⓓ It smoothly connects together the events experienced by the speaker.

Answer Key: D

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 48%

Reporting Category: Reading Prose and Poetry

Benchmark: ELA.4.R.1.4

Benchmark Description: Explain how rhyme and structure create meaning in a poem.

32. Which **two** details belong in a summary of Passage 1?

Ⓐ The speaker watches acrobats and elephants at the show.

Ⓑ Barnum selects the acts that are performed at the circus.

Ⓒ Thousands of people come to see the circus.

Ⓓ Barnum talks to the speaker after the show.

Ⓔ The speaker wants to be like Barnum.

Answer Key: D, E

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 30%

Reporting Category: Reading Across Genres & Vocabulary

Benchmark: ELA.4.R.3.2

Benchmark Description: Summarize a text to enhance comprehension.

33. How are Passage 1 and Passage 2 similar?

Ⓐ Both show a challenge in getting to the circus.

Ⓑ Both show a character wanting to be in the circus.

Ⓒ Both show how Barnum became a famous showman.

Ⓓ Both show that Barnum has a powerful effect on a character.

Answer Key: D

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 41%

Reporting Category: Reading Across Genres & Vocabulary

Benchmark: ELA.4.R.3.3

Benchmark Description: Compare and contrast accounts of the same event using primary and/or secondary sources.

34. In Passage 2, which sentence develops a theme that sometimes plans change unexpectedly?

Ⓐ "If she had any fears about whether the show would go on, they disappeared when the band started playing." (paragraph 2)

Ⓑ "There was a little girl named Flora Stirk who rode a bicycle and juggled." (paragraph 3)

Ⓒ "Nothing excited Josephine more, though, than the sight of a carriage rolling into the arena." (paragraph 4)

Ⓓ "At last, she would know how to succeed in America—if only she could speak!" (paragraph 8)

Answer Key: D

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 31%

Reporting Category: Reading Prose and Poetry

Benchmark: ELA.4.R.1.2

Benchmark Description: Explain a stated or implied theme and how it develops, using details, in a literary text.

35. Complete the table to show whether each idea is from Passage 1, Passage 2, or both passages.

	Passage 1	Passage 2	Both Passages
describes a character talking with Barnum	Ⓐ	Ⓑ	Ⓒ
mentions a character waiting in line to meet Barnum	Ⓓ	Ⓔ	Ⓕ
tells of a difficult trip for a character to see Barnum's circus	Ⓖ	Ⓗ	Ⓘ

Answer Key: C, D, H

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 48%

Reporting Category: Reading Across Genres & Vocabulary

Benchmark: ELA.4.R.3.3

Benchmark Description: Compare and contrast accounts of the same event using primary and/or secondary sources.

36. Read this line from Passage 1.

"After each act I applaud at what I saw." (line 10)

The word "applaud" comes from the Latin root word *laud*, meaning "praise." What does the word applaud mean in this line?

Ⓐ clap
Ⓑ laugh
Ⓒ smile
Ⓓ whistle

Answer Key: A

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 89%

Reporting Category: Reading Across Genres & Vocabulary

Benchmark: ELA.4.V.1.2

Benchmark Description: Apply knowledge of common Greek and Latin roots, base words, and affixes to determine the meaning of unfamiliar words in grade-level content.

37. In Passage 2, how does the event of traveling in the storm add to the plot?

Ⓐ It explains why the characters are tired.

Ⓑ It shows why the characters are late to the show.

Ⓒ It shows how badly the characters want to see the show.

Ⓓ It explains what makes the characters feel uncomfortable.

Answer Key: C

Percentage of Students Answering Correctly: 63%

Reporting Category: Reading Prose and Poetry

Benchmark: ELA.4.R.1.1

Benchmark Description: Explain how setting, events, conflict, and character development contribute to the plot in a literary text.



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